CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

HOME INSPECTOR IN THE AI ERA

The calmest job in housing: no hammers, no dust — you walk through homes with a flashlight and a checklist and get paid for what you notice.

★ TL;DR — Median around $75K for established inspectors, enterable in 1–6 months of training with a state license required in many states. The catch: it's a referral business — real-estate agents send the work, and your report quality (and liability) is the whole game. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

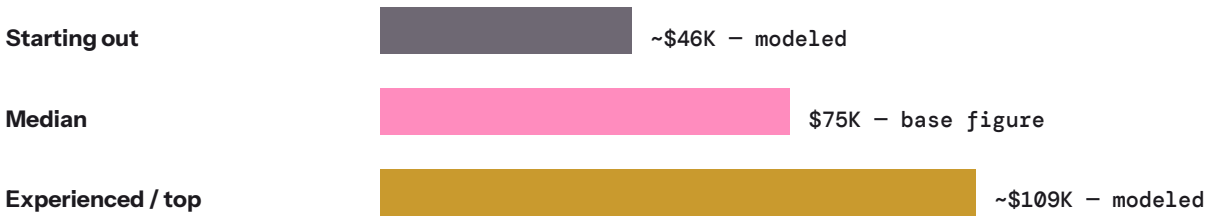
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Works because: nearly every home sale involves an inspection, and buyers pay for a trained eye on the biggest purchase of their lives.
- Bites because: work volume rides the housing market, and new inspectors must win agent referrals in a relationship business.
- AI angle: low-medium. Report software and photo analysis speed the paperwork; walking attics, testing systems and judging what's serious stays human — and licensed.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Home Inspector is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A HOME INSPECTOR ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Inspect homes system by system: roof, structure, electrical, plumbing, HVAC, interiors, exteriors
- ✓ Test, photograph and document defects — from dangerous wiring to a merely tired water heater
- ✓ Write clear, fair reports fast, then walk buyers through findings without panicking or whitewashing them
- ✓ Run the business side: scheduling, agent relationships, insurance, and standards compliance

Think: a physical exam for houses, with the report read by lawyers — thorough, neutral, and every word chosen carefully.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Report software assembles findings, and AI photo tools flag visible issues. They don't crawl the attic, smell the gas leak, run the shower to test drainage, or decide which crack is structural.	Trained observation and proportion: which defects are deal-breakers, which are maintenance, and how to say both honestly. Trustworthiness with agents and buyers — in a transaction full of incentives to shade the truth — is the profession's core.

⚠ **Liability is the shadow: miss something big and you'll hear about it, expensively — E&O; insurance is not optional in practice. And income follows home sales; slow housing markets starve new inspectors first.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Clean, indoor-outdoor work with no heavy labor ✓ Solo, scheduled, professional — ideal second-act trade career ✓ Every house is different; the detective work doesn't stale	✗ Attics in summer, crawlspaces in every season ✗ Feast-or-famine with the housing market ✗ Agents may prefer 'easy' inspectors — integrity has a marketing cost

Good fit? You have a construction or trades background, an eye for detail, and the temperament to be accurate under everyone's emotional weather.
Bad fit? You rush, hate writing, or fold under pressure from agents who want a softer report. The report is the product; pressure is the test.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — TRAINING + STATE LICENSE → OWN PRACTICE	DOOR B — MULTI-INSPECTOR FIRM
Complete an inspection training program aligned to national standards (ASHI/InterNACHI curriculum), pass the national exam, and take your state license where required. Most inspectors run their own small practice — marketing to agents and buyers is part of the job from day one.	Join an established firm as an inspector: steadier deal flow, training and report systems provided, in exchange for a revenue split. The faster door to full calendars — and a fine school for going independent later.

Smart move: Ancillary services are the margin: radon, sewer scopes, mold, thermal imaging, pool and WDO inspections. One visit, several paid add-ons — and agents prefer one call that covers everything.

Where you land after: Inspector → established practice with add-on services → firm owner with inspectors under you, or into commercial inspection.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
CHECK YOUR	COMPLETE INSPECTOR	PASS THE	DO SUPERVISED	WIN THE	STACK ANCILLARY

STEP 1 — Check your state's licensing rules

FREE · TODAY

- Many states license home inspectors with education, exam and sometimes field-experience requirements; some don't. Know your exact path.
- Line up E&O; and liability insurance quotes early — they're operating costs, not afterthoughts.

STEP 2 — Complete inspector training

$1,500-4,000 · 1-6 MO

- Full systems curriculum: structure, roofing, electrical, plumbing, HVAC, plus standards of practice and report writing.
- Programs with ride-along inspections are worth more than pure online theory.

STEP 3 — Pass the national exam, take the license

EXAM + STATE LICENSE

- Pass the National Home Inspector Examination, then complete your state license application where required.
- Join InterNACHI or ASHI — standards, training and credibility that agents recognize.

STEP 4 — Do supervised / first inspections

WEEKS

- Ride-alongs or firm training first; your first solo reports should be reviewed by someone with scar tissue.
- Build your report template and photo discipline — consistency is your liability shield.

STEP 5 — Win the referral engine

MONTHS

- Visit brokerages, sponsor agent education, be fast, fair and readable — agents rebook what makes them look good.
- Buyer-direct marketing (reviews, pre-listing inspections) diversifies you away from agent dependence.

STEP 6 — Stack ancillary services

YEAR 1+

- Add radon, sewer scope, thermal or pool certifications as your market demands.
- Each add-on raises per-visit revenue without another drive across town.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: read your state's inspector licensing requirements end-to-end; price E&O; insurance.
- □ Days 1–30: enrolled in training; systems coursework — structure and roofing first.
- □ Days 31–60: ride-along inspections; report-writing practice on real houses.
- □ Days 61–90: national exam sat or scheduled; state license application ready; first brokerage visits planned.
- □ Day 90: in the pipeline with exam and license in motion — the referral engine is the next build.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **NOTICE EVERYTHING. WRITE IT FAIR.** ★

certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.